

10 SKILLS YOU CAN LEARN FROM GAMES

THAT WILL ACTUALLY HELP YOU...
IN LIFE, COLLEGE, SCHOOL, ETC

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The reason you're going to immediately start reading this story is because you want to see if it's something you can show to your parents in order to get them to buy you a gaming rig, or to upgrade your existing one. Plus, you probably think this might get them off your back when you want to play games instead of doing chores... good luck with that. If your parents are frowning on your video gaming it probably has something to do with the way your life is going.

This article is not trying to justify your gaming binges, or validate your bias towards gaming, or even tell your parents off for being so old school in their beliefs. This is a factual article that aims to take a look at some of the benefits of gaming in moderation, and we want to specify: in moderation! There's a good reason parents try and regulate your gaming – it's because it's so darn addictive, and it makes it so easy for us to procrastinate. However, you have to do it in moderation, or else it can cause serious problems. We should know... if we didn't have an internal regulator that told us when we were going

too far, you'd never get to read another Digit magazine again because we'd all be passed out at our desks from exhaustion after playing games for days on end.

Enough preaching, however, because what this article will do from now on is focus on the several benefits that gaming can have for an individual, and how it can enhance your skills, or even give you all new skills that you couldn't learn anywhere else!

1 PROBLEM SOLVING SKILLS AND LOGIC

Even when you're playing games such as *Angry Birds*, or *Cut the Rope*, and especially when playing complex puzzlers like the *Portal* series, you're basically training your brain to think logically in order to solve the puzzles. Not only are you indulging in problem solving

and using the logic centres of your brain, you're being forced to do it within a time limit. This translates to a very real-world skill that you will often put to use at work.

One of the things many new recruits into the workforce struggle with is lateral thinking (thinking outside the box), and thinking fast, and on the job. Games certainly seem to help in that aspect.

2 FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS

This may seem like not a big deal at first, but a lot of employers and teachers complain about people not following instructions. Very often people don't treat an instruction as an order, and look at it as a guideline instead. This often means that you end up working in a way that doesn't please your employer or teachers. When you play a lot of games, especially ones that have quests and missions, you pay attention and listen up carefully, because you know that success or failure is determined by how much you follow the rules of the game. Real-life is pretty similar in that sense because sometimes it doesn't matter how silly a

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